

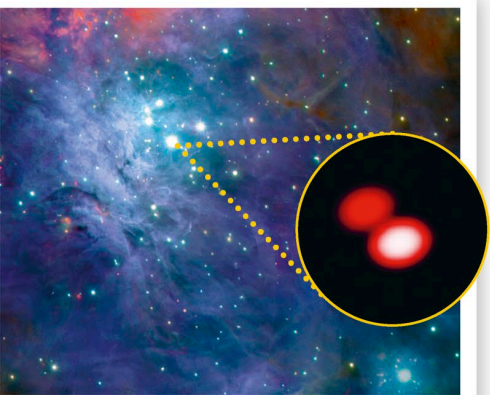
Life of a star

Stars live for millions of years. As a star grows older, it changes. The Universe contains young, middle-aged, and old stars. The biggest stars are more than 1,700 times wider than the Sun, and the smallest stars are much smaller than Earth.

Star colors

All stars are incredibly hot, but some are hotter than others. Blue-white stars are the hottest of all. Yellow-orange ones, like the Sun, are cooler. Red stars are the coolest of all. However, even red stars are more than 13 times hotter than a kitchen oven.

This star is middle-aged, like our Sun. However, its yellow-white color tells us it is hotter and brighter.



Seeing double

About 80 percent of the stars in the Universe are double stars. These are two stars that live together, or two stars that look close together because we are looking at them from such a long way away. Use binoculars to look for double stars.